

## Architectural styles

## RENAISSANCE

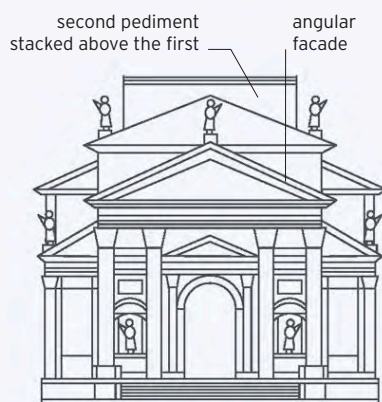
*Originating in Italy, the Renaissance saw the rebirth of Classical learning in Europe. In architecture, this manifested through a decisive break with medieval traditions and the embrace of the architectural styles of the ancient Roman world.*

The word Renaissance derives from the Italian *la rinascita*, meaning “rebirth.” Coming to the fore in the 15th century, the rebirth in question was of Classical models of learning, philosophy, literature, art, and architecture (see pp.96–97). Central to this was the emergence of Humanist thought, which prioritized human agency over received wisdom and ecclesiastical doctrine. Architecturally, this was manifested through a revival of interest in the architecture of the ancient world and the attempt to reposition architecture as an intellectual, liberal art as opposed to a craft.

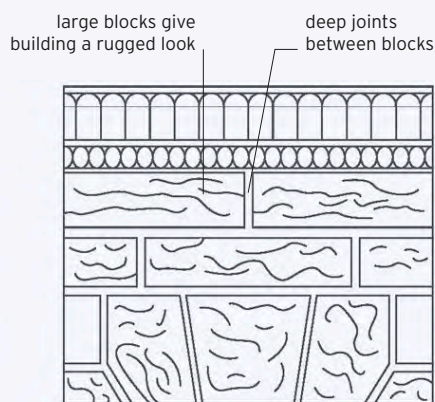
The architect Leon Battista Alberti was the foremost theorist of the early Renaissance, with his influential treatise *De re aedificatoria* (1454) arguing for Classical architecture’s fundamental basis on geometry deriving from nature. Subsequent treatises further codified Renaissance architectural principles, allowing for their dissemination and application across Europe.

The **only surviving book on architecture** from the ancient world was *De Architectura* by the Roman architect **Vitruvius**

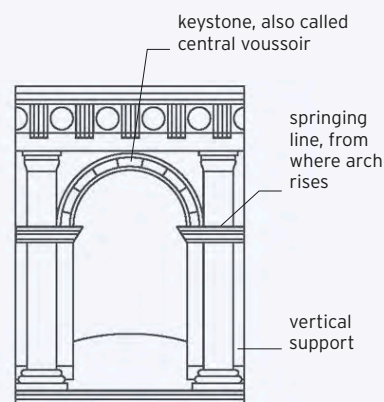
## CLASSICAL ARCHITECTURE REBORN



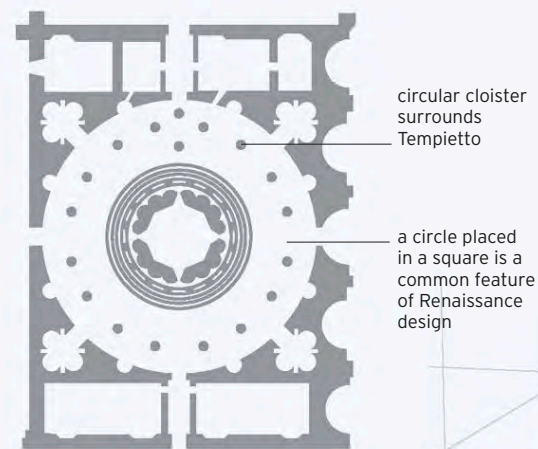
**△ SUPERIMPOSED PEDIMENTS**  
A superimposed pediment is one pediment placed above or behind another. It allows ceilings of two different heights but is also used as an expressive device.



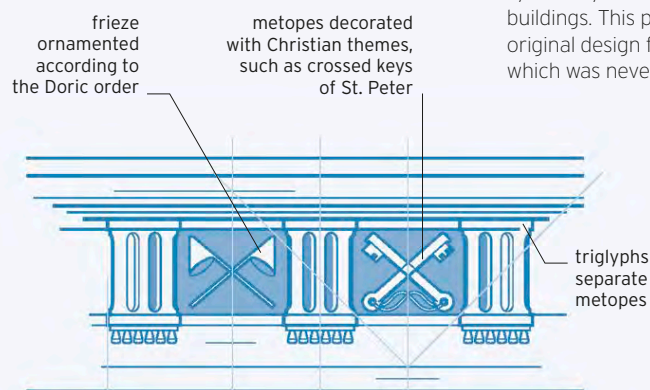
**△ RUSTICATED STONEMWORK**  
Rustication is the accentuation of the joints between adjacent stone blocks to emphasize their weight and solidity. It is frequently used in lower stories.



**△ ROUNDED ARCH**  
Gothic architecture was founded on the pointed arch. Renaissance architecture, in contrast, reverted to the rounded arch of the Romans, which it used in new ways.

**△ SYMMETRY**

Renaissance architects were deeply concerned with incorporating the symmetry found in nature in their buildings. This plan shows Bramante's original design for the Tempietto, which was never fully realized.

**△ FRIEZE**

Some Renaissance architects took the opportunity to tailor Classical building codes and systems to particular building types and patrons—for example, in the ornamentation of a frieze.

